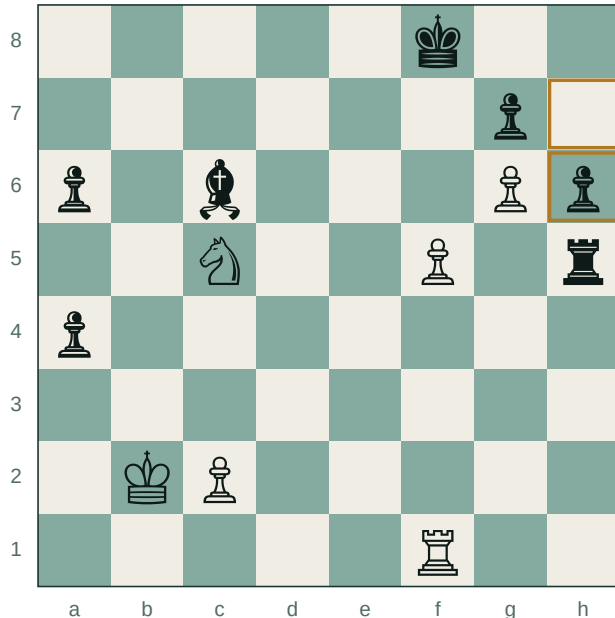


Deflection tactics: White, move 37

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 36...h6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Ne6+ Ke7 38. Nxg7

37.Ne6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **37...Ke7**.

38.Nxg7 The knight captures the pawn on g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c6 and rook on h5. Check for tactical protection.